(Kelsey, p. 68). 'Probably the most difficult period in these early years came in January 1989 when [our administrator] was let go and was replaced. [Then, the new administrator] struggled with personal problems and only lasted about six months on the job. That's when our treasurer discovered… a professional group specialising in running nonprofit organisations. [They were] given a one-year contract, but it was not renewed. We discovered that they simply had no idea what a woodturner was' (Kelsey, p. 70). 'Then we found [an administrator] who single-handedly rebuilt our computerised membership list and structurally saved the organisation with good administrative skills and an excellent memory. Equally if not more important, [this administrator] was a woodturner and spoke woodturning,' he explained.

Another early rock in the road focused on the articles that appeared in the *American Woodturner* journal. Ellsworth explained, 'All these articles were written by members. The problem was that there were many people out there doing important work both technically and aesthetically, but you couldn't get them to write about it, or if they had no writing skills, our ability to get valuable information our there was severely reduced. People rightfully complained that there would be one primary article in each issue and that rest was fluff, which in many cases was true' (Kelsey, p. 70). 'If an article wasn't directed to the weekend hobbyist turner and filled with technical information and pictures of flying shavings, it qualified as fluff… As an educator, I felt it was a responsibility to help our members grow in ways that went beyond their present experience beyond the lathe, beyond technique, even beyond wood, so that there was no glass ceiling to their own efforts as their personal skills increased. This also relates to my greatest personal frustration and the most perplexing element of any grassroots craft media organisation: How do you create and balance the needs of hobbyist, semi-professional, and professional makers, knowing that if you're doing your job, those needs will grow, will evolve, like cell division overtime?' (Kelsey, p. 71).

Alan Lacer was AAW's second president, serving from 1991 to 1994, a time of rapid growth and organisational maturation. Lacer recounted his experience: 'My first years on the board found me in the midst of a struggling organisation. The days of financial turmoil, survival loans, discussions of shutting down the AAW, relocating our office, multiple administrators, petitions, and the like, played an important role in the shaping of this organisation. As painful as those times were, they helped formulate a mission and vision for survival and growth. In the struggle to exist, we probably had the closest working relationships within the board, with volunteers and with the editor and administrators that we have ever seen,' Lacer explained (Kelsey, p. 79).

The AAW also faced some procedural and organisational obstacles, and needed to improve membership records and create an efficient system for tracking membership dues. The first step to improving AAW's financial situation was discovering that journals were being sent to 3,700 addresses, everyone in the database, when only 1,700 of them were current paid-up members. Looking back, there has been quite an evolution of the process for organising managing, and exchanging information (Kelsey, p. 174).

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Left to right: William Moore, Kevin Wallace, and Frank E. Cummings take part in a 2012 symposium panel discussion

PHOTO: ANDI WOLFE

Artist Cindy Drozda shares secrets of successful finial turning at the 2015 AAW symposium

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